Chapter 22: Closing Remarks

Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 22 (pp. 823-829)

Overview

Chapter 22 (pp. 823-829) closes the book by restating Jager's purpose and dispelling **seven common myths** about the TOGAF Standard (pp. 823-828). The chapter has no numbered sections. Leave with this idea: most criticism of TOGAF comes from misunderstanding it, from not reading it carefully, from outdated exam knowledge, or from hearsay. The Standard is a flexible, tailorable, business-wide EA framework, not a rigid IT documentation process (p. 828). Chapter 22 is part of the PINK reading tour (p. 823).

> **Reading note:** The myths and rebuttals are Jager's. He supports them with quotations from the Standard: the "essential scaffolding" quote (p. 825), the generic-deliverables quote (p. 826), and "The Architecture Development Method should not be understood as a process model" (p. 828). The closing reprises his four reasons for writing from Chapter 1. Small inconsistency: p. 828 mentions "four different types of iteration", while Chapter 13 describes three *ways* to iterate and four iteration *groups*.

Detailed Section Breakdown

Opening (p. 823)

- TOGAF is still highly relevant and complete, with methods and techniques for an effective approach. Yet many practitioners don't apply it as intended, because of the volume of information and its sometimes vague or academic explanation. This creates room for myths (p. 823).

The Seven Myths (pp. 824-828)

Myth	Jager's rebuttal	Links	Page
1. TOGAF is only for large organizations	Frameworks are size-independent, scalable, and adaptable. Every organization benefits from translating goals into operational impact	Ch. 17	p. 824
2. TOGAF is rigid and prescriptive	It is highly flexible and meant to be tailored. "The essential scaffolding... is the concepts. Everything else... is either an example or a starter set"	Ch. 17	p. 825
3. TOGAF is only about IT Architecture	Technology is one of four domains (Business, Data, Application, Technology). It is an EA framework with a holistic view. It refers to BIZBOK rather than duplicating it	Ch. 4.2, 11	pp. 825-826
4. TOGAF replaces other frameworks	It doesn't compete with Zachman, SAFe, ITIL, or COBIT. Its generic deliverables "may be replaced or extended by a more specific set" from other frameworks	Ch. 16	pp. 826-827
5. TOGAF is outdated	It keeps evolving (digital transformation, cloud, agile). New editions every few years, while the core stays stable	Ch. 2, 18, 19	p. 827
6. TOGAF is just about documentation	Nowhere does it say so. It needs four key documents with set structures, but not endless documentation. The repository should hold building blocks, not elaborate solution diagrams	Ch. 7.1, 12.2	pp. 827-828

Myth	Jager's rebuttal	Links	Page
7. The ADM must be followed step by step	The graphic shows information flows, not a sequence. "The ADM should not be understood as a process model." It is tailorable and iterative	Ch. 13.3, 12.13	p. 828

- **Why the myths persist.** Not reading the content carefully, relying on outdated knowledge (e.g., from an old TOGAF exam), and accepting hearsay (p. 828).

Closing (pp. 828-829)

- **What the book did.** Refuted the myths with practical examples, presented a practical approach, and covered the most important parts plus extra context (pp. 828-829).
- **Four reasons for writing (restated).** Explain and clarify the methodology; present a practical approach; show how to correctly apply and tailor the framework; and so refute unfounded criticism (p. 829; see Ch. 1).
- **Delivered.** Fundamental concepts explained, actionable steps given, tailoring of the metamodel, Content Framework, and ADM demonstrated, with examples of implementing EA (p. 829).
- **Final message.** Use TOGAF "as it was intended: in a practical and pragmatic way that can be tailored to the situation" (p. 829).

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Page
Myth (about TOGAF)	A common misconception that stems from not understanding how the theory is applied	p. 823
Generic deliverables	TOGAF's default deliverables, which may be replaced or extended by other frameworks' specific sets	pp. 826-827

Figures & Tables Referenced

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
Figure 22-1	Four core architecture domains	p. 826

Self-Check Questions

Q: List the seven myths about TOGAF.

A: Only for large organizations; rigid and prescriptive; only about IT Architecture; replaces other frameworks; outdated; just about documentation; the ADM must be followed step by step (p. 824).

Q: How does Jager refute "TOGAF is only about IT"?

A: Technology is only one of four core domains. TOGAF covers Business, Data, Application, and Technology, giving a holistic EA view (pp. 825-826).

Q: What should, and should not, be stored in the Architecture Repository according to the documentation myth?

A: Architecture and Solution Building Blocks should be stored, not elaborate solution diagrams, matrices, or catalogs (p. 827).

Q: What does the Standard say about using other frameworks' deliverables?

A: TOGAF may be used in its own right, or its generic deliverables may be replaced or extended by a more specific set from any relevant framework (p. 826).

Q: Why do the myths persist, according to Jager?

A: Careless reading of the framework, outdated knowledge (e.g., from old exams), and accepting hearsay without thinking (p. 828).

Q: What are Jager's four reasons for writing the book?

A: To explain and clarify TOGAF's methodology; to present a practical approach; to show how to correctly apply and tailor it; and thereby to refute unfounded criticism (p. 829).